

The Clockmaker's Apprentice: answers

Year 5 · 12 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Seven minutes to eight. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A detail to find in the second paragraph.

2. Between the teeth of the biggest wheel. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). Finding the key detail that solves the mystery, inside a longer sentence.

3. muttering (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Finding the word that shows how people spoke builds vocabulary and attention to detail.

4. Mr Hollis, the clockmaker, had been ill for weeks, so there was nobody else to do it. (1 mark)

Inference (2d). Linking two facts that sit in different parts of the story to explain why a character acts.

5. It was very small, quiet and scratchy, but still noticeable if you listened carefully. (2 marks)

Language choices. Understanding what a simile suggests, not just spotting it.

6. He listened carefully (“listening”) and followed the sound until he found the nest jammed in the wheel. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Connecting something said early in the story to what happens later.

7. A good answer says that patience and careful listening can solve problems that seem too big or difficult (accept: kindness to animals, trusting yourself), with a reason from the story. (2 marks)

Summarising (2c). Identifying the main idea behind a whole story.

8. He is kind and careful: he wanted the sparrows to be able to find their nest again. (2 marks)

Giving a view with evidence. Deciding what a character's actions show about them.